

Speak with one **voice**.

This playbook gives every Elevator the words, tools, and confidence to represent Elevate powerfully — in any room, to any audience, at any time. It is also a leadership guide for team leads carrying this vision to their teams.

 elevateng.org

 [@elevateng](https://twitter.com/elevateng)

 hello@elevateng.org

Ages 13–30 · Makoko & Paikon-Kore

— SECTION 01

Who We Are

Before you can communicate Elevate to others, you must own it yourself. This is the foundation everything else is built on.

OUR VISION

*A future where young Africans have access to the **mindset, tools, and opportunities** to break the cycle of poverty — and transform their communities.*

OUR MISSION

*To lift **1 million young Africans** out of multidimensional poverty through mindset shifts, education, employment, and innovation.*

Our Values

These are not decorations. They are how we work — every day, with every person.

Faith in Jesus

We stand by the principles of Jesus. It is our aim to reflect His love for humanity through every project, interaction, and decision we make.

Commitment

We are volunteer-run, but we work like we are paid to do what we do. The mission demands our best — not our convenience.

A Servant's Heart

We serve our beneficiaries with a heart full of love and empathy. Their dignity is always more important than our program metrics.

Honesty

The impact made in our beneficiaries' lives is the single most important thing that drives us. We never exaggerate. We let real transformation speak.

The Three Pillars of Our Work

Everything Elevate does runs through these three lenses.



Education

Our beneficiaries learn productive thinking patterns and acquire useful knowledge — formally and informally.



Enlightenment

Our beneficiaries sharpen their discernment and decision-making. They begin to see themselves and the world differently.



Empowerment

Our beneficiaries turn internalised knowledge into real value — for themselves and their communities.

Our Transformation Pathway — The How

This is what separates Elevate from every other program. A clear, structured journey — not isolated sessions.

STAGE 1

Mindset

Metanoia Bootcamp
Mental Liberation
Purpose Discovery



STAGE 2

Skills

Digital Training
Mentorship Program
EdVenture · Career Guidance



STAGE 3

Launch

Employment pathways
Social enterprise support
Community leadership

Every program Elevate runs must map to one of these three stages. This is the model. This is what you are communicating when you talk about Elevate.

Our Why

*"I hate what poverty does to people created in the **image of God.**"*

*To serve is a privilege. To do otherwise would be to be **misaligned with purpose.***

— Abiola Adebisi, Founder

We believe that where a young person **starts** should not determine where they **end**. We believe transformation is possible — not accidentally, but through structure, discipline, and the right systems. That belief is why we show up.

What Makes Elevate Different

SYSTEM, NOT MOMENTS

We don't run one-off events. We run a three-stage pathway: Mindset → Skills → Launch. The program doesn't end when the session does.

TRANSFORMATION, NOT ATTENDANCE

We don't celebrate showing up. We celebrate what changes. Every beneficiary has a before and an after. We measure the gap between them.

COMMUNITY-ROOTED

We work in communities — Makoko Village (Lagos) and Paikon-Kore (Abuja). We do the needs assessment. We don't design from a boardroom and deliver from a distance.

REPLICABLE AT SCALE

Everything we build is documented, standardised, and designed to be handed to others. We're building a model, not just a program.

What Elevate is — and is not

We are not just another NGO running workshops. We are not a charity that gives handouts. We are not here to make people dependent on us.

We are a system builder. We design and deliver a structured transformation pathway. We equip young people to stand on their own — and to lift others when they do.

The Pitch

Every Elevator should be able to answer "what does Elevate do?" in 10 seconds, 30 seconds, or 2 minutes — with the actual model, not cliché language. Memorise the pathway. It is your anchor.

THE ONE SENTENCE — MEMORISE THIS FIRST

"Elevate builds structured pathways that move underserved young Africans from low exposure to economic productivity — through mindset, skills, and launch."

 Copy one-liner

Pitch Scripts

Read these first. Then make them yours. The pathway — Mindset, Skills, Launch — must be in every version. That is the differentiator.

10 seconds

The pathway is always in this version: Mindset → Skills → Launch

"Elevate takes underserved young Nigerians through a three-stage program — we work on mindset first, then build real skills, then help them launch into work or enterprise. We've reached 376 young people so far. The goal is 1 million Africans."

Use when: Someone asks "what do you do?" in passing, at an event, or online. Name the three stages. Let them ask more.

 Copy this pitch

30 seconds

Open with the problem. Name the person. Deliver the three stages. Close with a result.

"In Nigeria, millions of young people between 13 and 30 are stuck — secondary school students with no direction, young people who dropped out, and adults still waiting for something to move. Elevate exists for them. We run a structured three-stage program: first we work on mindset, helping young people break limiting beliefs and discover purpose. Then we build real, marketable skills — digital training, mentorship, career

guidance. Then we help them launch — into employment, businesses, or community leadership. In 2024 alone, 95% of our participants upskilled, and 68% applied what they learned to their real lives. We're not running workshops. We're running a system. And the goal is 1 million Africans."

Use when: You're introduced to someone new at a meeting, a potential partner, or a donor asks what you do. This is your standard pitch.

 Copy this pitch

2 minutes

Start with Bola. Build the three stages with detail. End with the data and the vision.

"Elevate Development Foundation exists because of young people like Bola. She's 18. She could be 15 still in school, or 22 and out of it — she — but nothing is moving. She doesn't see a future. If nothing changes, she becomes another person who had potential but never accessed it. That's the problem we're solving.

We work in underserved communities across Makoko Village (Lagos) and Paikon-Kore (Abuja). Our programs run a clear three-stage pathway. Stage one: Mindset. Through our Metanoia Bootcamp and Mental Liberation programs, we work on how young people see themselves and the world. We help them break through the mental barriers that keep them stuck. Stage two: Skills. We build real, marketable capability — digital training, structured mentorship with industry professionals, and career guidance through our EdVenture program. Stage three: Launch. We connect young people to employment pathways, support social enterprise, and develop community leaders.

In 2024, we reached 376 young people — 88% above our target. 95% upskilled. 68% implemented what they learned in their real lives and careers. 100% received meaningful guidance from trained mentors.

We're not running events. We're building a replicable system. And we're doing it because we believe where you start should not determine where you end. The goal is 1 million Africans."

Use when: You're in a funder meeting, presenting at an event, or being interviewed. Take your time. Name each stage clearly. The specificity is what makes it credible.

 Copy summary version

Social Media Versions

Always include the three stages. That's the differentiator online too.

INSTAGRAM / TWITTER BIO

LINKEDIN VOLUNTEER DESCRIPTION

"Mindset → Skills → Launch. Structured transformation for underserved African youth. Road to 1 million. 🇳🇮 elevateng.org"

 Copy

"Volunteer at Elevate Development Foundation — running a three-stage transformation pathway (mindset, skills, launch) for underserved young Nigerians aged 13 to 30 — in and out of school. Mission: 1 million Africans. elevateng.org"

 Copy

Know Your Audience

Same mission. Different language. The pathway stays the same — how you explain it changes based on who is in front of you.

The rule: Lead with what matters to *them*. Every audience has an unspoken question. Your job is to answer it — not just tell them about Elevate. Listen first. Then speak.



Funders & Partners

Their question: "Will my investment make a real difference?"

LEAD WITH

Impact data. Numbers first, story second. Then name the three stages clearly.

KEY LANGUAGE

"Three-stage pathway" ·
"Measurable outcomes" ·
"Scalable model" · "We track transformation, not attendance"

EXAMPLE OPENER

"In 2024, we reached 376 young people through our mindset-to-launch pathway. 95% upskilled. Here is how the model works..."

WHAT TO AVOID

Vague language. Asking for money before showing the system and its proof.



Potential Volunteers

Their question: "Is this worth my time? Will I grow?"

LEAD WITH

The vision and the system. Then what their specific role is inside it. Then the ask.

KEY LANGUAGE

"You will own a part of this" ·
"Real deliverables" · "You will see the impact directly" · "We are building toward 1 million"

EXAMPLE OPENER

"We run a structured three-stage transformation program. We need people who want to build it — not just join it. Here is what that looks like specifically..."

WHAT TO AVOID

Overselling the fun. Underselling the work. Do not recruit people who just want a certificate.



Parents & Families

Their question: "Is my child safe? Is this worth their time?"

LEAD WITH

Safety and structure. Walk them through what their child will actually experience at each stage.

KEY LANGUAGE

"Trained mentors" · "We track progress at every stage" · "We work in partnership with families"

EXAMPLE OPENER

"Your child will go through three stages with us: mindset and confidence, then real skills with professional mentors, then launch."

WHAT TO AVOID

Anything that sounds like pulling children away from family. Elevate is an addition to their support system, not a replacement.

Community conversations are the most nuanced and the most important. The context changes everything. Here are the five situations you will encounter and exactly how to approach each one.



Language Advisory

Consider delivering community conversations in the language of the community — Yoruba, Igbo, Hausa, or Nigerian Pidgin English. The message lands deeper in someone's first language. It also signals respect: that you came to meet them, not to perform for them. If you are not fluent, bring someone who is. Never let language become a barrier to trust.

1

First Visit — Cold Entry

THEY DO NOT KNOW YOU. TRUST IS ZERO. YOU HAVE NOT EARNED THE RIGHT TO PITCH YET.

The principle: Do not pitch Elevate on a first visit. Your only job is to show up, listen, and prove you are different from every organisation that has come and gone before. Ask more than you speak.

WHAT TO DO

Come with no visible agenda. Introduce yourself as someone who wants to understand the community before doing anything in it. Ask: "What are the biggest challenges young people here face?" and "What programs have come here before — what worked, what did not?" Listen. Take notes. Do not counter or defend. Thank them and tell them you will be back.

"We are here first to listen. We have seen too many organisations come into communities with a program already designed. We do not want to do that. Before we bring anything, we want to understand what this community actually needs and what it has already been through."

2

The Gatekeeper Conversation

COMMUNITY LEADER, CHIEF, PASTOR, SCHOOL HEAD, OR PARENT ASSOCIATION CHAIR. THEY OPEN OR CLOSE THE DOOR.

The principle: Never go around the gatekeeper. Go through them with full respect. Your goal is their endorsement, not just their permission.

WHAT TO DO

Come with a written one-pager about Elevate. Acknowledge their role and authority first. Explain the three stages clearly and simply. Show the impact data. Ask for their input: "What would make this work for this community?" Incorporate their response genuinely. Do not move into the community without their blessing.

"We do not come to do anything in this community without your knowledge and your support. We believe that any program without the community leader behind it cannot truly serve the community. So we came to you first — to explain what we do, to hear your perspective, and to ask for your guidance."

3

Speaking Directly to Young People

ONE-ON-ONE OR IN A GROUP. THEY ARE SCEPTICAL. PROGRAMS HAVE COME AND GONE BEFORE.

The principle: Do not open with what Elevate does. Open with what they are experiencing. The moment they feel seen, the wall comes down. Only then do you explain the pathway.

WHAT TO DO

Start with a question, not a presentation: "How many of you feel like things should be moving by now — but they are not?" Let them respond. Acknowledge it without pity. Then: "That is not your fault — and it is not who you are. There is a specific reason things feel stuck, and there is a specific path out of it." Then walk through each stage in plain, direct language. Avoid formal terminology.

"Before we do anything else, we want to understand where you actually are — not where people assume you are. We are going to start by working on something most programs skip: how you think about yourself and what is possible for you. Because no skill works if you do not believe you can use it. We start there."

4

The Sceptical Parent or Guardian

THEY HAVE SEEN PROGRAMS FAIL BEFORE. THEY ARE PROTECTIVE. THEY ARE WORRIED ABOUT THEIR CHILD'S TIME.

The principle: Acknowledge their scepticism directly. Do not defend against it — validate it. Then show them specifically what is different at each stage of this program.

WHAT TO DO

Lead with: "I understand you have seen organisations come here before and things did not change." Let that land. Then: "We are asking you to give us a specific period of time — and we will show you specific changes in your child at the end of it. Not just that they attended. What they can now do, how they think, and where they are headed." Show them how you track each young person individually.

"Your caution makes complete sense. We are not asking for blind trust. We are asking for a trial — with clear evidence at the end. Before your child starts, we understand where they are. After the program, we show you both exactly what changed. If nothing changed, we want to know that too. That honesty is how we get better."

5

Returning to a Community You Have Already Worked In

TRUST EXISTS — BUT SO DOES ACCOUNTABILITY. HONOUR WHAT CAME BEFORE BEFORE YOU ASK FOR MORE.

The principle: Before you say anything about what is next, acknowledge what happened since you were last there. Communities remember. Lead with honesty and trust deepens. Skip it and it erodes.

WHAT TO DO

Open by naming specific outcomes from your last engagement. Share what you learned. Be honest about what you would do differently. Present the next phase as a continuation of a relationship, not a new sell. Bring evidence: photos, testimonials, outcome data from the previous cohort.

"When we were here last time, we worked with [number] young people. Here is what happened with them since — [specific outcomes]. Here is also what we realised we could have done better. We are back because this community matters to us, not because we have a new program to sell. We want to go deeper with what we started."

Selling the Vision to Communities — When They Just Want Quick Help

This is the hardest conversation. The people we serve are often hustling day to day. They are sceptical of structured programs. They want immediate relief — money, food, a quick skill. Your job is not to dismiss that. It is to show them, in a way they can see and feel, that the pathway we offer leads to something far more lasting than any one-off help ever could.

THE CORE PRINCIPLE

Do not argue against what they want. Acknowledge it fully. Then paint a picture of what is possible if they choose the longer road — and make that picture so specific, so personal, so imaginable, that the longer road becomes the obvious choice.

⚠ What Not to Do

Do not lecture them about sustainability. Do not say "handouts do not work." Do not make them feel small for wanting immediate help. That closes the door immediately. Start where they are. Validate what they feel. Then invite them into something bigger.

The Community Storytelling Framework

Use this structure when speaking to a community group or individual beneficiary who is on the fence. Keep the language simple. Use their world, not yours. Make it visual and personal.

STEP 1 — START WHERE THEY ARE

Name their reality without pity. Show them you understand the pressure they are under — family, money, time. Use specific, grounded language, not abstract descriptions of poverty.

"I know most of you wake up thinking about today. What to eat. What to sell. How to help at home. You do not have time for something that might work in six months. That makes sense. I am not here to pretend it

does not."

STEP 2 — TELL A STORY THEY CAN SEE THEMSELVES IN

Use Bola or a real beneficiary story. Keep it in plain, vivid language. Age-appropriate. Set it in a world they recognise — their kind of community, their kind of family.

"Let me tell you about someone like you. Bola was 17. She was helping her mother sell at the market in the mornings. In the afternoon she had nothing structured to do. A relative suggested she join our program. She almost did not come. But she did. And I want to tell you what happened."

STEP 3 — WALK THEM THROUGH THE JOURNEY STAGE BY STAGE

Do not use program names or formal language. Describe what actually happens to a person at each stage in plain terms they can picture. Make each stage feel like a real, tangible change.

"In the first weeks, we did not start with any skill. We started with how she sees herself. We asked her questions nobody had asked her before. What do you want? What are you good at? What has been holding you back? And slowly — she started to answer differently. She started to stand differently."

STEP 4 — SHOW THEM WHAT THEIR LIFE LOOKS LIKE AFTER

This is the most important step. Make the future imaginable. Specific. Personal. Connect it to their family, their community, their daily life — not abstract success. Let them see December from here.

"Eight months later, Bola was earning. Not a lot at first — but it was hers. She was the one her mother started calling when there was a problem to solve. She was the one the younger ones on her street came to for help. Something had changed in her that nobody could take away. That is what we are offering you. Not a shortcut. Something real."

Addressing the "I Just Need Quick Help" Directly

When someone says it plainly — "I need money now, not a program" — do not dodge it. Address it head-on, with honesty and warmth.

WHAT THEY SAY

"I do not have time for a six-month program. I need something now."

HOW TO RESPOND

"I hear you. We are not asking you to stop surviving. We are asking you to add something to your week — a few hours — that changes where you are heading."

WHAT THEY SAY

"Programs have come here before. Nothing changed."

HOW TO RESPOND

"You are right to be careful. We cannot promise we are different just by saying it. What we can do is show you — come for two sessions. If you do not see

Quick help keeps you where you are. This moves you somewhere different."

something real, walk away. We are not here to waste your time."

WHAT THEY SAY

"What about my family? I cannot just be doing programs."

HOW TO RESPOND

"That is exactly who we are working for — your family. The young person who goes through this program is the one who can eventually carry the family forward. This is not for you alone. It is for everyone depending on you."

WHAT THEY SAY

"Will I be earning money at the end?"

HOW TO RESPOND

"We are honest with you: we cannot guarantee a specific income. What we can guarantee is that you will leave with a real skill, a clearer direction, and connections to people who can open doors. That is what leads to earning. We help you build the foundation."

WHAT WE ARE COMMITTED TO

We are not against helping people. We are against help that leaves people in the same place it found them. Everything we do is designed to grow our beneficiaries — not to create dependency, not to give a one-off experience, not to make ourselves feel good. The commitment is to lasting change. That is what we sell. That is what we deliver.

The Universal Rule



Listen First

Before you pitch, understand who you are talking to. Ask one question and listen fully before responding.



Name the Pathway

In every conversation, name Mindset → Skills → Launch. That is what makes Elevate specific and credible.



End with Invitation

Every conversation ends with a next step. A follow-up visit, a meeting, or "visit elevateng.org."

The Story Framework

Facts tell. Stories move people. This four-part framework lets anyone on the team tell Elevate's story powerfully — in a conversation, a post, a presentation, or an interview.

01

THE PROBLEM

Start with what's broken. Name the reality your audience can feel. Don't sugarcoat it.

02

THE PERSON

Put a human face on it. Make it specific. Bola is your anchor. Use her name.

03

WHAT WE DO

Name the three stages: Mindset, Skills, Launch. Be specific. This is the how.

04

WHAT CHANGES

End with transformation. Not what we hope — what we've already seen happen. Use data.

FULL EXAMPLE — READ THIS, THEN MAKE IT YOURS

THE PROBLEM

"In Nigeria, millions of young people finish school and walk into nothing. No job. No direction. No one helping them figure out what's next. The potential is there — but there's no system to unlock it."

THE PERSON

"Think about Bola. She is 17. She is still in secondary school — or maybe she had to drop out last year. She is smart — but she doesn't know it. She doesn't see a path forward. She's not lazy. She's just never been shown the way. If nothing changes, she becomes another person who had potential but never accessed it."

WHAT WE DO

"That's why Elevate exists. We take young people through a structured three-stage pathway. First: Mindset. We work on how they see themselves — breaking through the mental barriers that keep them stuck. Second: Skills. We build real, marketable capability — digital training, professional mentorship, career guidance. Third: Launch. We help them take what they've built into work, enterprise, or community leadership. We don't just run sessions. We follow through."

WHAT CHANGES

"Bola came in confused and uncertain. Six months later, she was earning, building, and speaking with a clarity she didn't have before. That's not a miracle — that's a system working. 95% of our participants upskill. 68% apply what they learn to real life. And we're building this toward 1 million young Africans."

The Data You Should Know

These numbers back the story. Memorise them. Quote them with confidence and precision.

376

Youths reached in 2024 —
88% above target

95%

Of mentees upskilled and
improved confidence

68%

Applied learnings directly
to life and career

100%

Received meaningful
guidance from mentors

Social Media Templates

Same four-part framework — just shorter. Always name at least one stage of the pathway.

IMPACT POST TEMPLATE

"[Name] came to us with [challenge].

*We started with mindset. Then skills. Then
helped them launch.*

Six months later: [specific outcome].

*That's the Elevate pathway. Not hope — a
system.*

#ElevateNG #MindsetSkillsLaunch"

 Copy template

CALL TO ACTION TEMPLATE

*"28% of Nigerian youth are not in education,
employment, or training. That's not a statistic —
that's a generation without a pathway.*

*Elevate runs a three-stage program: Mindset →
Skills → Launch. We've reached 376 young
people. The goal is 1 million.*

elevateng.org #ElevateNG"

 Copy template

Questions You Will Be Asked

Ten questions that come up most often — with clear, honest, confident answers.

Read them. Absorb them. Make them yours. Click each to expand.

"Is Elevate just another NGO? There are so many of them."



Fair question — and it deserves a direct answer. **Most organisations run programs. We build a system.** The difference is that a program runs and stops. Our three-stage pathway — mindset, skills, launch — is structured, documented, and repeatable. We measure outcomes at every stage. We follow through after the session ends. We're building something that can be handed to others and run at scale. That's not what most NGOs are doing.

"We've seen too many programs come and go. We're not interested in being one of them. We're interested in what actually works — and we can show you what that looks like in practice."

"How do I know it actually works?"



Lead with data, then story. In 2024, we reached 376 young people — 88% above our target. 95% improved their skills and confidence. 68% applied what they learned directly to their lives and careers. 100% received meaningful guidance. We don't count attendance — we measure change at each stage of the pathway. We have a monitoring and evaluation framework that tracks every beneficiary from baseline to outcome.

"We can show you the numbers. But more than that, we can introduce you to the people behind the numbers. Their stories are the real proof."

"What does my money or support actually do?"



Be specific. Funding directly pays for program delivery: the Metanoia Bootcamp (Stage 1), digital training and mentorship sessions (Stage 2), and career and enterprise launch support (Stage 3). We operate on a 70/30 principle — at least 70% of funds go directly to programs. We publish impact reports so you can see exactly what happened with every contribution.

"Your support shows up in a specific stage of a young person's journey. We'll tell you exactly which one — and what changed because of it."

"Why should I trust you?"



We're not asking for trust on faith. We've been operating since 2016. We have documented programs, real outcome data, and real people whose trajectories changed. We share our impact reports publicly. We're honest about what hasn't worked. **We don't ask for trust. We earn it — one published result at a time.**

"Don't take our word for it. Come see a session. Read the report. Talk to someone we've worked with. Visit elevateng.org. The evidence is there."

"What's Elevate's long-term plan? Will it last?"



We're building for sustainability, not dependency. Our model has two connected arms: the Foundation (community programs, grant-funded delivery) and the Institute (paid training, curriculum licensing, consulting for schools and organisations). The Institute generates revenue that funds the Foundation. As our model gets standardised, we'll deploy a franchise system — trained fellows running our pathway in communities across Nigeria and Africa. Target: 10,000 youths by 2027. 1 million by 2029.

"We're not building something that depends on one donor or one team leader. Systems outlast people. That's the point."

"You're volunteers — can you really build something serious?"



Acknowledge it directly. **Yes, we're primarily volunteer-run — and we're actively working to change that.** We're building our first paid team now. But here's what we've proven: a committed volunteer team, running a structured three-stage pathway with proper monitoring and evaluation, can produce real measurable impact. The 2024 results didn't happen by accident. We worked like we're paid to do what we do.

"Commitment is a value we hold. The impact shows it. And we're now building the paid structure to match the ambition."

"How is Elevate different from [other organisation]?"



Never criticise others. Instead, **be so specific about what you are that the comparison becomes irrelevant.** Name the three stages. Explain what happens at each one. Describe how you measure transformation — not attendance. Explain the follow-through after sessions end. That specificity is the differentiator. No one else is telling you exactly what happens in Stage 1, 2, and 3 of their program.

"We respect the work others do. What we can tell you is exactly what Elevate does — and let you judge whether the approach makes sense."

"Why focus on underserved communities specifically?"



Because the gap is greatest there — and because that's where the mission lives. Young people in underserved communities have the same potential as anyone else. What they lack is access — to the mindset shift that comes from being challenged and believed in, to marketable skills, to people who can open doors. Potential is evenly distributed. Opportunity is not. Elevate closes that gap through a structured pathway — not charity.

"Where you start should not determine where you end. That conviction drives every stage of our program."

"Can I get involved? What would I actually do?"



Be specific about what you need and what they'll get. Three ways: volunteer (defined role, real weekly deliverables, direct part in the pathway), mentor (share professional expertise in Stage 2 with beneficiaries), supporter (financially or in-kind). Be honest: this means real work and real accountability. In return: growth, direct impact, and being part of something building toward 1 million Africans.

"We're not looking for people who want to help. We're looking for people who want to build. There's a difference — and it matters to us."

"The 1 million goal — is that realistic?"



Own the ambition. Then explain the logic. Africa has over 400 million youth. Nigeria alone has over 70 million. 1 million is large in absolute terms but a fraction of the need. Reaching it requires scale — which is why we're building a replicable three-stage pathway, a franchise model, and a training institute that others can learn from. The goal is big because the problem is big. And we have a system designed to match it.

"We don't apologise for the size of the goal. We think the problem demands it. And we're building the system to reach it."

Internal Leadership Guide

For team leads. The vision only works if it lives inside the team — not just in presentations to outsiders. This section gives you the tools to carry it inward.

The challenge: Team leads often know the vision but struggle to translate it into the day-to-day. The result is a team that executes tasks without understanding why those tasks matter. This section fixes that. Five tools — each one practical, each one usable in your next team meeting.



Tool 1: Opening the Room

How to start every team meeting with the mission — without it feeling forced

WHY THIS MATTERS

A team that begins every meeting by diving into tasks is a team that will eventually lose the thread of why the tasks matter. The vision needs to enter the room before the work does — even if only for 90 seconds.

THE RITUAL

Open every meeting with one of three anchors — rotate them:

(1) The number: State where we are on the journey to 1 million. Even "we're at 376" reminds the team the goal is real and we're moving.

(2) The person: Name one beneficiary. One stage they're at in the pathway. What changed.

(3) The question: Ask one reflection question before starting — "What did any of us do this week that moved someone closer to Stage 3?"

SCRIPT TO USE

"Before we get into the work — we are at 376 young people on the road to 1 million. Every task



Tool 2: Course Correction

When a team member is off-track — how to bring it back to the mission without it feeling like a telling-off

THE PRINCIPLE

Course correction done well is not criticism — it's realignment. The question is not "why didn't you do it?" but "does what you did serve the mission?" That reframe changes the whole conversation.

THE FRAMEWORK: REALIGN, DON'T BLAME

Step 1 — State the gap: Name what didn't happen, specifically and without drama.

Step 2 — Connect to impact: Explain which beneficiary or stage of the pathway was affected.

Step 3 — Ask, don't tell: "What got in the way?" Listen fully before offering solutions.

Step 4 — Recommit: "What will you do differently this week?" Get a specific answer.

SCRIPT TO USE

"The mentorship check-ins didn't happen this week. That means the mentees in Stage 2 went without guidance. I want to understand what got in the way — and then I want us to figure out

*on today's agenda is connected to that number.
Let's keep that in front of us."*

*together how we make sure it doesn't happen
again. What happened?"*

WHAT TO AVOID

Don't shame. Don't accept "I was busy" without pressing for the specific blocker. Don't let the conversation end without a concrete next step committed to.



Tool 3: Celebrating the Right Things

How to recognise wins in a way that reinforces the values
— not just the activity

THE PROBLEM WITH GENERIC PRAISE

When you celebrate effort indiscriminately, you build a culture that values showing up over delivering. Elevate's culture celebrates outcomes — transformation, follow-through, and accuracy to the mission.

WHAT TO CELEBRATE PUBLICLY

- ✓ **A beneficiary moves from Stage 1 to Stage 2** — name it
- ✓ **A team member delivers without being chased** — name it
- ✓ **A partner or funder responds positively** — name it
- ✓ **Someone solves a problem without involving the founder** — name it loudly
- ✓ **A mentor shows up consistently** — name it

HOW TO NAME IT WELL

Be specific. Connect the win to the mission. Don't just say "great job" — say what the person did and why it mattered to a real beneficiary or to the goal of 1 million.

SCRIPT TO USE

"I want to name something [Name] did this week. She followed up with three mentees who had gone quiet — without being asked. Two of them re-engaged. That is exactly what Stage 2 follow-



Tool 4: The Hard Conversation

When accountability needs to happen — holding the standard while keeping the person

THE PRINCIPLE

Accountability is an act of respect. Holding someone to their commitments says: I believe you are capable and I take your word seriously. Avoiding it says the opposite. Do not avoid it.

WHEN TO USE THIS

Use when a team member has repeatedly missed deliverables, is not showing up with the standard Elevate requires, or when goodwill is being substituted for output.

THE FRAMEWORK: DIRECT, KIND, SPECIFIC

1. Name the pattern, not just the incident: "This is the third week in a row."

2. State the impact: "The beneficiaries in your care are not being supported the way they should be."

3. Ask what's really happening: Listen for the real blocker — capacity, motivation, personal challenges.

4. Agree on what changes: Specific, measurable, time-bound.

5. Name the consequence clearly if needed: "If this continues, we will need to rethink your role."

SCRIPT TO USE

"I want to have an honest conversation with you. For the last three weeks, [deliverable] hasn't been done. That matters — because it means [specific

through looks like. That is Elevate's standard.
Thank you."

impact on beneficiaries or team]. I'm not here to blame you. I want to understand what's really happening. But I also need to be clear: this is the standard Elevate holds, and I need to know you can meet it. What's going on?"



Tool 5: Re-motivating a Disengaged Volunteer

When someone has gone quiet, pulled back, or lost the fire — the conversation that brings them back or helps them exit with dignity

WHY THIS HAPPENS

Volunteers disengage for three main reasons: **they feel unrecognised** (their work isn't being seen), **they feel unclear** (they don't know what they're supposed to be doing or why it matters), or **their life circumstances have changed** (capacity genuinely isn't there). Each requires a different response.

THE CONVERSATION FRAMEWORK

Step 1 — Check in as a human first: "How are you? I've noticed you've been quieter — I want to check in before I assume anything."

Step 2 — Name what you've observed: Specific. Not accusatory. "I've noticed you haven't submitted your updates for the past two weeks."

Step 3 — Ask open questions: "What's changed?" or "Is the role still working for you?"

Step 4 — Reconnect to the why: Remind them of the mission and where their role sits inside it. Make it personal. "You were the person who [specific thing they did]. That mattered."

Step 5 — Offer a real choice: Re-engage with a modified role if needed, or step back with full dignity. "It's okay to take a step back if that's what you need. It's not okay to disappear without us knowing."

SCRIPT: WHEN THEY FEEL UNRECOGNISED

"I realise I haven't told you recently what your work has meant to the team. [Specific thing they did] genuinely moved things forward. I don't want you to feel like that went unnoticed. I want you back in the room — what would make that feel worth it again?"

SCRIPT: WHEN THEY'VE LOST THE WHY

"Let me remind you why you're here. The beneficiaries in your part of the pathway — [Stage 1 / 2 / 3] — are real people. When you're not showing up, they feel it. You signed up for something that matters. I believe you still believe that. Tell me what's making it hard to show up right now."

SCRIPT: WHEN THEY NEED TO STEP BACK

"I hear you — your capacity has changed and that's completely understandable. Here's what I need: a clear decision, not a fade. Either we find a smaller role that you can actually commit to, or we give you a proper send-off and leave the door open for when life has space again. Which would serve you better right now?"

Leading Teams Not Directly in the Field

Project teams feel the impact naturally — they see the beneficiaries, they run the sessions, they hear the stories. But Media, Tech/Innovation, and People Experience teams often do not have that direct contact. Their motivation can fade faster. Their connection to the mission can feel abstract. This is where team leads must work harder to bridge the gap.



Media Team

They tell the stories — but can feel disconnected from the people inside them

THE REAL RISK

Media team members can slip into treating content as content — graphics to post, captions to write, metrics to hit. When that happens, the work feels empty and motivation drops. The fix is to make the person behind every piece of content real to them.

HOW TO LEAD THEM

1. Connect every brief to a beneficiary. Before any content is created, the team lead names who it is about or who it is for. Not "we need a post about the bootcamp" — "we need a post about what happened to Bola in Week 1 of the bootcamp."

2. Take them to the field. Even once a quarter, a media team member should attend a session, not to capture content, but to be present as a person. That experience changes how they write.

3. Show them the reach data and the response. When a post connects — a comment from someone saying it moved them, a funder who reached out — share that with the team immediately. That is their impact.

SCRIPT: RECONNECTING A MEDIA TEAM MEMBER

"The post you made about the Metanoia Bootcamp got a response from a school in Abuja asking if we could bring the program there. That one post opened a door for potentially hundreds of young people. I want you to know that. Your work is not just content. It is reach. And reach is how we get to 1 million."

WHAT TO CELEBRATE WITH THIS TEAM



Tech / Innovation Team

The most abstracted from impact — risk of feeling like they are building features, not changing lives

THE REAL RISK

Tech team members can get lost in the product — the platform, the LMS, the design. Without a clear line back to a beneficiary whose life their work affects, motivation becomes about the build, not the mission. When the product hits friction, they have nothing to hold onto.

HOW TO LEAD THEM

1. Always name the beneficiary the feature serves. Not "we are building the MEL tracker" — "we are building the system that tells us whether Bola's confidence actually improved, so we can serve her better." Every feature has a face.

2. Show them the problem before the solution. Before briefing a new build, show them the current pain point from the beneficiary's or program team's perspective. Let them feel the gap their work is closing.

3. Validate when the work lands. When a system works — when data helps a program team make a better decision, when a platform saves time for a mentor — name it to the tech team explicitly.

SCRIPT: RECONNECTING A TECH TEAM MEMBER

"The MEL tracker you built means our program team can now see in real time which beneficiaries are at risk of dropping out of Stage 2 before they actually do. Last month it flagged three young people who are still in the program because of that early warning. You built that. That is what your code does in the real world."

WHAT TO CELEBRATE WITH THIS TEAM

A post that generates a genuine inquiry · A story that a beneficiary says represents them accurately · Content that a funder references in a meeting · Consistent, quality storytelling over time

A system that the program team actually uses consistently · A tool that saves a mentor time · A platform decision that improves a beneficiary's experience · Clean, reliable work that does not need fixing



People Experience Team

They serve volunteers, not beneficiaries directly — easy to feel like the mission is happening elsewhere

THE REAL RISK

People Experience team members can feel like administration — scheduling, onboarding, managing spreadsheets. If they do not understand that a well-supported volunteer directly produces a better program for a beneficiary, they lose the thread of why their work matters. Their work is the invisible infrastructure that holds the mission up.

THE CORE REFRAME FOR THIS TEAM

Every beneficiary Elevate reaches is reached *through* a volunteer. The quality of that volunteer's experience — how well they are supported, how clear their role is, how valued they feel — directly determines the quality of the program the beneficiary receives. People Experience is not support work. It is mission-critical infrastructure.

HOW TO LEAD THEM

1. Show the chain. Regularly draw the explicit connection: "When you onboard a mentor well, they show up prepared. When they show up prepared, the mentee trusts the process. When the mentee trusts the process, they move from Stage 1 to Stage 2. That chain starts with you."

2. Share volunteer success stories as their wins.

When a volunteer grows, steps up, or produces something excellent — that is a People Experience win. Name it that way.

3. Involve them in impact moments. Invite a PE team member to sit in on a program session once a quarter. Not to manage anything — to see the end result of the environment they are building.

SCRIPT: RECONNECTING A PE TEAM MEMBER

"The mentor you onboarded last month has now completed six sessions with her mentee group. Three of them have moved to Stage 2. She told me she felt so well-prepared for the role that she never felt lost. That preparation started with how you welcomed her and set her up. Three young people are further along their pathway because of that. I want you to own that."

SCRIPT: WHEN PE TEAM FEELS LIKE ADMIN

"I know this week felt like a lot of spreadsheets and scheduling. But I want you to understand what that spreadsheet does: it is the difference between a mentor showing up to the right session at the right time with the right resources — and not. When that goes wrong, a young person in Makoko or Paikon-Kore has a worse experience. When it goes right, they do not even notice — and that is exactly what it should be. Your job is to make the mission invisible and frictionless."

WHAT TO CELEBRATE WITH THIS TEAM

A volunteer who says they felt well-supported · A new team member who onboarded smoothly · A difficult exit handled with dignity · Low volunteer dropout in a quarter · A team culture moment that strengthened belonging

The Team Lead Across All Teams

Regardless of which team you lead — the principle is the same. Your team members need to be able to draw a straight line from what they do on a Tuesday afternoon to a young person in Makoko Village or Paikon-Kore whose life is different because of it. If they cannot draw that line, they will eventually stop caring. Your job is to draw it for them — regularly, specifically, and with conviction.

"Your volunteers will mirror your conviction. If you are uncertain, they will be uncertain. If you are clear about why this matters, they will be clear. The vision travels through you first — into your team, and through them into the community."

The Team Lead's North Star

Your job is not to manage tasks. Your job is to carry the vision into the room and make sure every person on your team understands how their specific role in the pathway connects to a real young person's life changing. When the team loses that thread, you bring them back to it. Not once — consistently, every meeting, every check-in, every conversation.

"Your volunteers will mirror your conviction. If you are uncertain, they will be uncertain. If you are clear about why this matters, they will be clear. The vision travels through you first."

Dos, Don'ts & Quick Reference

Pull this up before any meeting, interview, presentation, or post. Everything you need in one place.

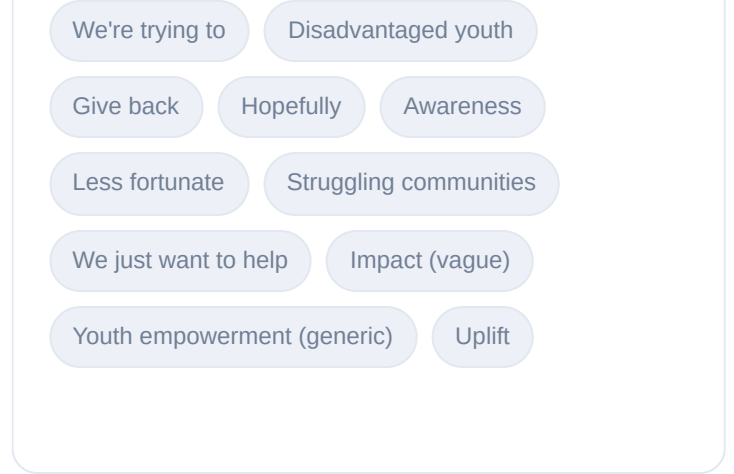
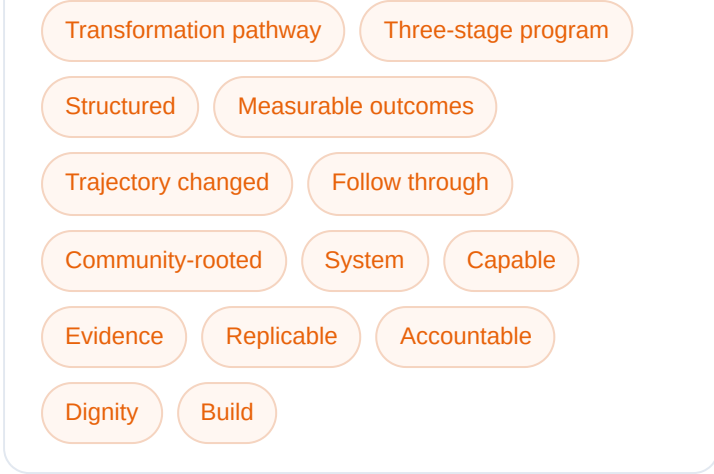
*"You are not just a volunteer. You are **a representative of a vision** that could change a million lives. Carry that with the weight it deserves — and the joy it produces."*

✓ DO THIS	✗ DON'T DO THIS
✓ Name the three stages in every pitch: Mindset, Skills, Launch.	✗ Don't pitch without naming the pathway. "Structured programs" alone is too vague.
✓ Lead with impact data when talking to funders. Numbers first, story second.	✗ Don't use pity language about beneficiaries. They are capable people who need opportunity.
✓ Use Bola's story to make the mission human and real.	✗ Don't say "we're trying to help youth." Be specific about how.
✓ Be honest about being volunteer-run — and what you're doing to change that.	✗ Don't promise things Elevate hasn't committed to delivering.
✓ Listen before you pitch. Ask what matters to the person in front of you.	✗ Don't criticise other organisations. Define yourself, not them.
✓ End every conversation with a clear next step. Send them to elevator.org .	✗ Don't apologise for the ambition. 1 million is the goal — say it with conviction.
✓ Speak with confidence. You represent something real that works.	✗ Don't ask for money or commitment before establishing trust.
✓ When you don't know something, say so — and follow up.	✗ Don't represent Elevate in a way you wouldn't want the founder to see.

Language Guide

Words carry weight. The pathway language is precise — use it deliberately.

✓ USE THESE WORDS	✗ AVOID THESE WORDS
Mindset → Skills → Launch	Poor kids Helpless Charity



Quick Reference Card — Before Any Conversation

ONE SENTENCE

"We build structured pathways that move underserved young Africans from low exposure to economic productivity — through mindset, skills, and launch."

KEY DATA

376 youths in 2024 (88% above target) · 95% upskilled · 68% applied learnings · 100% received guidance

FOUNDED & OPERATING

2016 by Abiola Adebisi. Makoko Village (Lagos) and Paikon-Kore (Abuja).

OUR WHY

"Where you start should not determine where you end."

THE MISSION NUMBER

1 million young Africans lifted out of multidimensional poverty.

THE THREE STAGES

Stage 1: Mindset (Metanoia Bootcamp, Mental Liberation) → Stage 2: Skills (Digital Training, Mentorship, EdVenture) → Stage 3: Launch

WEBSITE & SOCIAL

elevateng.org · @elevateng · hello@elevateng.org

WHAT MAKES US DIFFERENT

Three-stage pathway · Transformation not attendance · Community-rooted · Replicable at scale · We follow through

You are part of something that could change a million lives.

Speak like it.

Elevate Development Foundation · Vision Playbook · Internal Use Only

elevateng.org · @elevateng · hello@elevateng.org